

Expense Reimbursement Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy explains what business expenses Solarium reimburses, how to submit them, approval limits, and the corporate card program. The guiding principle: spend company money as carefully as you'd spend your own, and when in doubt, ask before you buy rather than after.

2. Submission Process

- 1 Submit expenses through the expense system within **30 days** of the expense being incurred. Expenses submitted after 60 days require Controller approval and may be denied, since late submission complicates accounting close and budget tracking.
- 2 Attach an itemized receipt for any expense over \$25. A credit card statement line alone is not sufficient — we need the itemized receipt showing what was purchased, not just the total.
- 3 Categorize each expense correctly (travel, meals, software, client entertainment, etc.) — the system will prompt you if a category needs additional detail (e.g., attendee names for a meal over \$75).
- 4 Your manager approves expenses up to their delegated authority (see Section 8); anything above that routes automatically to the next approval level.
- 5 Approved expenses are reimbursed via direct deposit on the next regular payroll or expense payment cycle, typically within 5–10 business days of final approval.

3. What's Reimbursable

Category	Reimbursable	Notes
Business travel (flights, trains, rental cars, rideshare, hotel)	Yes	Book through the approved travel portal where possible; see Section 4
Meals while traveling for business	Yes, up to \$75/day	No receipt itemization required under \$25 within the daily cap
Client meals and entertainment	Yes	Requires attendee names/companies and business purpose noted
Team meals (in-office or offsite, manager-approved)	Yes	Reasonable per-person amount; check with your manager for team-specific norms
Home internet / phone (ongoing)	Covered separately	See the Home Office Stipend in SOL-OPS-201, not this policy
Conference and training registration	Yes, with manager pre-approval	Include a one-line note on expected takeaways for anything over \$500

Category	Reimbursable	Notes
Books, courses, professional certifications	Yes, up to \$1,000/year with manager approval	Submit under "Professional Development"
Coworking space day passes (remote employees)	Yes, up to 2 days/month	No pre-approval needed under the monthly cap
Parking and tolls for business travel	Yes	
Personal entertainment while traveling (movies, minibar, spa)	No	
Traffic or parking fines	No	Even if incurred during business travel
Airline seat upgrades / lounge access	No, unless medically necessary or on flights over 6 hours in a role requiring immediate post-flight work	Rare exception, requires Controller pre-approval
Spousal/partner or family travel costs	No	Unless specifically approved in advance for a defined business reason (e.g., a relocation-related trip)

4. Travel Booking

- Book flights and hotels through the approved travel portal whenever it's available for your route — this gets Solarium's negotiated rates and keeps duty-of-care tracking (knowing where traveling employees are, in case of an emergency) working correctly.
- Economy class for flights under 6 hours; premium economy is reimbursable for flights over 6 hours; business class requires VP-level approval and is generally reserved for international travel over 9 hours.
- Book at least 14 days in advance where the travel is planned rather than urgent — this significantly reduces cost and is factored into whether a late-booked, more expensive fare gets fully reimbursed.
- Rental cars: mid-size or smaller unless carrying equipment or 3+ colleagues requires a larger vehicle. Decline the rental company's insurance add-on — Solarium's corporate policy already covers it (details in the travel portal).

5. Corporate Card Program

- Employees who travel regularly (estimated 4+ trips/year) or manage recurring vendor spend are eligible for a Solarium corporate card, requested through Finance with manager approval.
- Corporate card transactions still require the same receipt and categorization process as out-of-pocket expenses — a card does not remove the need to submit and categorize.
- Personal charges on a corporate card are not permitted, even if you intend to reimburse Solarium yourself; if it happens accidentally, report it to Finance promptly and reimburse via the process Finance provides — this is treated as a mistake, not a violation, if reported and corrected promptly. Repeated personal use without prompt correction is treated more seriously.
- Lost or stolen corporate cards should be reported to the issuing bank and to Finance immediately.

6. Mileage and Personal Vehicle Use

- Business use of a personal vehicle (not your normal commute) is reimbursed at the current IRS standard mileage rate, updated annually and posted in the expense system.
- Log mileage through the expense system's mileage tool (start/end location and purpose) rather than a flat estimate.
- Normal commuting between home and your regular office is never reimbursable, consistent with standard tax treatment.

7. Non-Reimbursable Expenses — Common Examples

To reduce back-and-forth, here are things employees commonly ask about that are **not** reimbursable:

- Commuting costs to your regular office (see Section 6)
- Home office furniture and equipment beyond the stipend/equipment programs in SOL-OPS-201 and SOL-OPS-202
- Personal subscriptions (streaming, gym memberships) even if used partly for work purposes, unless specifically part of an approved wellness benefit (see SOL-HR-103)
- Gifts to colleagues (birthdays, farewells) — these are typically pooled informally by teams, not an expensable category
- Alcohol at team meals beyond a reasonable amount (2 drinks/person is a reasonable default; ask your manager if unsure) — client entertainment has more latitude but should still be reasonable
- Any expense that primarily benefits you personally rather than the business, even if incurred during a work trip

8. Approval Limits by Role

Approver Level	Single Expense Limit
Manager	Up to \$2,500
Director	Up to \$10,000
VP	Up to \$50,000
Controller / CFO	Above \$50,000, or any expense flagged as unusual by the system

Expenses are also subject to each team's overall budget, tracked separately from these per-transaction approval limits — an expense can be within approval authority but still questioned if it pushes a team over budget, in which case Finance will loop in the relevant manager before final approval, not after payment.

9. Disputed or Denied Expenses

If an expense is denied or reduced, the expense system shows the reason (e.g., missing receipt, over policy cap, wrong category). You can resubmit with additional information or documentation. If you believe a denial was made in error, contact your manager first, then Finance (finance@solarium.example) if unresolved. Denials are never

intended as a judgment about your integrity — the large majority are simple documentation or categorization issues.

10. International and Multi-Currency Expenses

Expenses incurred in a foreign currency are converted at the exchange rate on the transaction date, using the rate provided automatically by the expense system (based on standard published rates, not your personal card's markup rate) — do not manually convert and enter a USD amount yourself, as this can create reconciliation mismatches.

Related documents: SOL-OPS-201 (Remote and Flexible Work Policy — home office stipend), SOL-HR-103 (Benefits Guide — wellness stipend).